



New Directions in Philosophy of Suffering

What is suffering? How does it differ from pain, depression, and other negatively valenced states? Does suffering have special ethical significance? How does it interact with identity and integrity? What is the relationship between suffering and desire? This one-day workshop will explore new philosophical and historical work on these and related topics.

Planned talks include:

- Garrett Cullity (ANU) “The Badness of Suffering”
- Bronwyn Finnigan (ANU) “Buddhism and suffering 101”
- Eamon Little (ANU) "The Medicalisation of Suffering and the Business of Medicine”
- Louise Richardson-Self (University of Tasmania) "The (under)diagnosis of endometriosis: epistemic and affective injustices in the medical niche”
- Nanette Ryan (National University Singapore) and Colin Klein (ANU) “Suffering, Construal and the Struggle for Integrity”

For a full schedule, see: https://www.colinklein.org/workshops/SufferingProgram.pdf

The workshop will be Friday 6 Nov 2026, from 9am-5pm, in Lectorial 2 of the RSSS Building (Ground floor, 146 Ellery Crescent)

Attendance is free, but for catering purposes please register via email to colin.klein@anu.edu.au



